



By Stan Hochman

Second-Guessing the Phillies' Lineup

The Phillies are going to keep doing it until they get it right. Gonna clinch the East Division gonfalon in Montreal, just like they did last year.

Remember? A lot of bad champagne splashed around the clubhouse, a lot of tears and hugs and handshakes and then a hangover that lasted until the Reds swept 'em three in a row in the playoffs.

The wrath of grapes. Dick Allen split at the airport, heading home instead of going to St. Louis with the team. Grumbling about Danny Ozark's "clinching" lineup which included Jerry Martin in Ollie Brown's slot.

WELL, ALLEN was sighted recently shoveling out a stable at Bowie, and won't be available to orchestrate this year's clinching party.

Maybe the club ought to skip the champagne too. Order up a case of sarsaparilla and two large pizzas. One plain. One half-mushroom, half-kielbasi. And let Tim McCarver and Tug McGraw send out for Big Mcs for everybody.

Tastykakes for the rookies and a string of Chinese firecrackers for

Jay Johnstone. Sounds like a terrific party.

But you can't have the party 'till you clinch the gonfalon, and you can't clinch the gonfalon until you make out a lineup.

THE FAIREST WAY would be to have Danny Ozark pick the lineup out of a hat as soon as the magic number shrinks to one. Two problems with that approach.

First, you'll have to make sure Ozark is told the magic number is down to one. And secondly, the last time Danny picked a lineup out of a hat, the first name he drew was "Stetson."

No, there are other ways. If Ozark wanted to get even for all those ethnic cracks he could send out this lineup of current and former Phils:

Billy Grabarkewitz, 2b; Ted Kazanski, ss; Hugh Poland, c; Rip Repulski, lf; Mike Rodgozinski, 1b; Bob Sadow-ski, 3b; John Wyrostek, rf; John Vukovich, cf; Steve Ridzik, p.

Danny could say, "I like that lineup, not because they're Polish, but because I'm Polish."

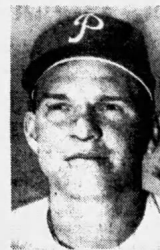
And Bruce Keidan would probably scowl and say, "Yeah, Danny, but Johnny Wyrostek wasn't Polish."



Ozark



Allen



Kazanski

And Ozark would just shrug and moan, "There you go again, Bruce, second-guessing me."

As a nostalgia move, Ozark could start a lineup of guys making under \$100,000:

But, after listing Freddy Andrews, 2b; Mike Buskey, ss; Barry Foote, c; John Vukovich, 3b; Randy Lerch, p; and Warren Brusstar in the bullpen, that leaves some gaps, unless he wants to activate his coaches.

How about an All-American melt-

ing pot lineup to please everybody?

Danny could start Larry Bowa, ss; Ted Sizemore, 2b; Greg Luzinski, lf; Garry Maddox, cf; Mike Schmidt, 3b; Jay Johnstone, 1b; and McGraw, McCarver and McBride with Andy Cohen on the coaching lines.

If Danny felt like making friends with the morning newspaper columnist, he could do it with this batting order:

Mike Rogodzinski, lf; Craig Robinson, ss; Dane Iorg, 1b; Bill Nahorodny or John Stearns, c; Bill Robinson, 3b;

Rick Bosetti, cf; Roger Freed, rf; Freddy Andrews, 2b; Carl Morton, p; with Dave Downs and Dave Wallace in the bullpen.

Frank Lucchesi could take the tear-stained lineup to home plate. Jim Bunning and Cal Emery could do the coaching.

OZARK COULD OPT for experience and send out a lineup of guys who have played in a World Series but he'd run out of guys after listing Richie Hebner, Dave Johnson, Tim McCarver and Steve Carlton.

How about the loyalty lineup and just use guys signed originally by the Phillies.

Fred Andrews, 2b; Larry Bowa, ss; Terry Harmon, rf; Bob Boone, c; Greg Luzinski, lf; Jerry Martin, cf; Mike Schmidt, 3b; John Vukovich, 1b; Larry Christenson, p.

And after they clinch it, Ozark could play the imports the next day:

Ollie Brown, lf; Dave Johnson, 2b; Tim McCarver, c; Richie Hebner, 3b; Jay Johnstone, 1b; Garry Maddox, cf; Bake McBride, rf; Mike Buskey, ss; Steve Carlton, p.

Ah, maybe the easiest thing to do is use the old schoolhouse method, alphabetical order. Ozark could win with that one too:

Fred Andrews, 2b; Bob Boone, c; Larry Bowa, ss; Mike Buskey, 3b; Ollie Brown, lf; Barry Foote, 1b; Terry Harmon, cf; Richie Hebner, rf; Tommy Hutton, p.

Can't you just hear Bill Conlin sneering, "Danny," Conlin would mutter, "Brown goes before Buskey."

And Ozark would roll those sad eyes and moan, "There you go again, Conlin, second-guessing me."